OPS PRIORITIES

Where We're Focusing

Top priorities, agreed as a team. Together, this is how we answer Play to Win's Delivery Excellence and Operational Review asks. We're tackling one epic at a time, starting with the Deal-to-Delivery Playbook, and moving to the next once it has real momentum.

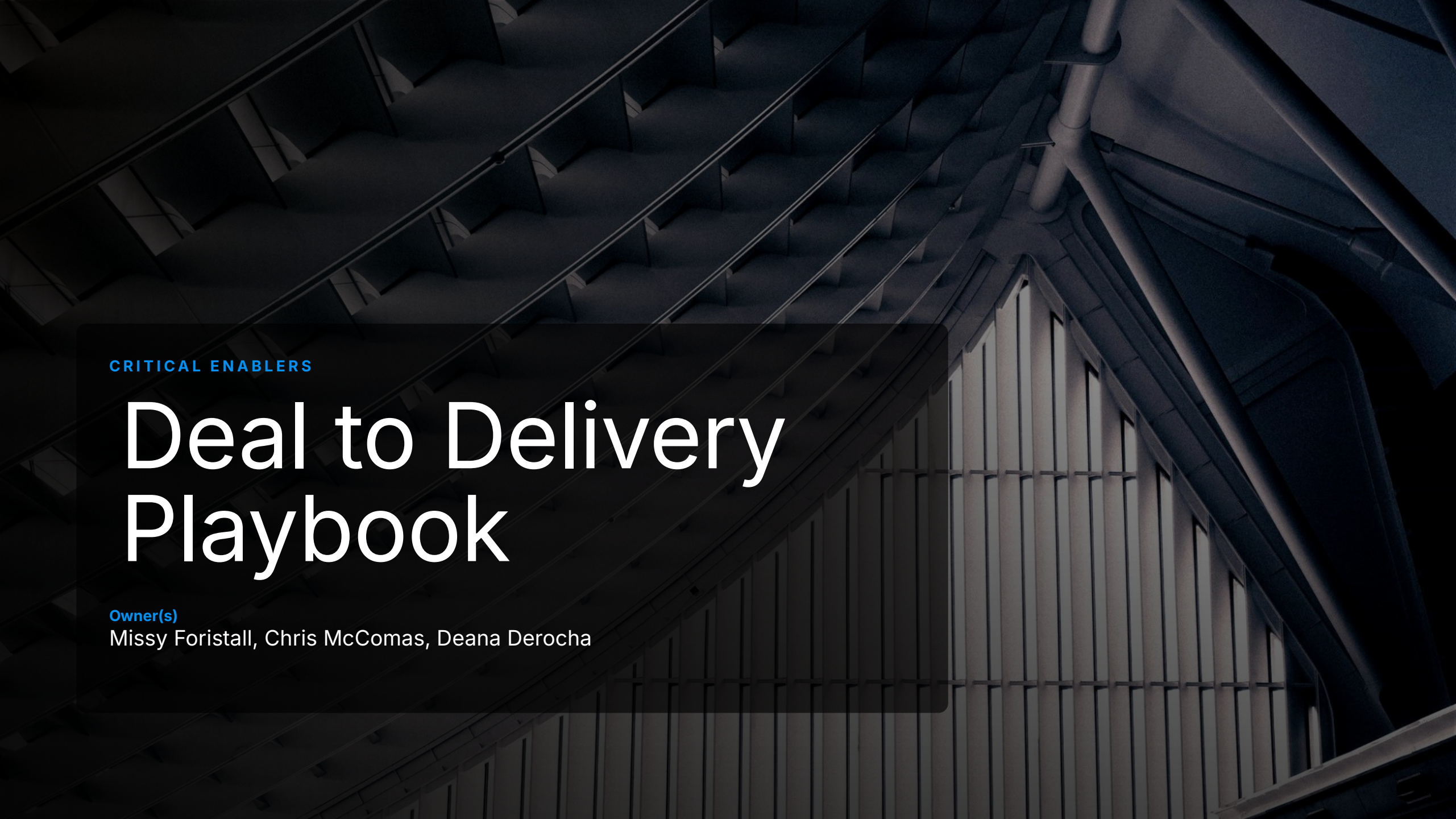
TOP 4 PRIORITIES

Deal-to-Delivery Playbook	Work is sold in shapes we cannot staff or deliver.	FOCUS NOW
Accountability Framework	Define accountability for every project, with clear delivery roles, executive sponsorship, and regular reviews that highlight high risk projects.	NEXT
Leadership Dashboards	One leadership dashboard — shoring, chargeability, margin, capacity, forecast, rate cards, burn, and revenue recognition.	NEXT
Capacity Planning & Romulus	Closing the skills and bench visibility gap so we can staff ahead of demand.	NEXT

ALSO SHORT-TERM · OTHER INITIATIVES

DGS Leadership Transition	Naazneen departs 12/31 — two-phase effort to map dependencies, resolve Extentia's operating model, and set leadership coverage.	FOCUS NOW
Intake Updates	Upstream of Delivery Models — alias routing is live; SME case request tool and RACI updates underway to close adoption gaps.	IN MOTION
Ops Transformation: Rebuild Scoping & Staffing	Deliverables go in, and a timeline and staffing plan come out, with AI doing real work and learning from what we deliver.	TAKING SHAPE
Earlier Delivery & Talent in Pursuits	Bring SME expertise into upfront deal evaluation to lift our win rate on the deals we already capture.	QUICK WIN

Source: All Hands slide 16 (first six); Delivery Excellence kickoff slide 4 (Ops Transformation, Earlier Delivery)



CRITICAL ENABLERS

Deal to Delivery Playbook

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, Chris McComas, Deana Derocha

CRITICAL ENABLERS

Deal to Delivery Playbook: Context

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, Chris McComas, Deana Derocha

2026 GOAL

Align how we scope, execute, and set client expectations, so what we sell is what we deliver.

- In practice: each deal is sold on a named delivery model, with contract, scope and billing matched to it, and delivery follows that same shape from qualification through staffing.

THE PROBLEM

- Work is sold in shapes we cannot staff or deliver.
- There is no standardized, named set of delivery models that is declared at the point of sale, carried into contracting, enforced at staffing and used for delivery.
- The delivery approach is decided implicitly by whoever is making decisions at that moment, and it is often not understood until the symptoms are visible to the client or a pivot needs investment.

WHAT WE ARE CHANGING

- Every engagement and every track gets a named delivery model from a small, standard set, declared before review and staffing.
- No SOW is signed without a model name attached, and that name determines governance.
- **Four starting models**
- Fixed Constraint Delivery, Velocity Based Delivery, Outcomes Based Delivery, Retainer
- **MVP: three stories, all three must work together**
- Delivery Models, Contracts, Methodology Standards

WHAT THIS UNLOCKS

- We stop agreeing to unfeasible combinations, like fixed-price with no scope control.
- Our pricing tools reflect true deliverability, not just theoretical margin.
- We guide clients into how we work instead of inheriting whatever mix they bring.
- **Beyond the MVP**
- Supported by AI: estimation, pricing, and staffing follow once the MVP is solid, and we move toward metered or token-based commercial pricing.

KEY TAKEAWAY

If we do nothing else, we must stop selling what we cannot properly deliver.

Why now

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, Chris McComas, Deana Derocha

Why this one, first: of the four, this is the most urgent to solve. Work is being sold in shapes we cannot staff or deliver, and that's costing us today — not a future risk. It's also our clearest answer to Play to Win's Delivery Excellence ask.

WHAT'S HAPPENING TODAY

There is no standardized, named set of delivery models, from which an individual or set of models is required to be declared at the point of sale, carried into contracting, enforced at staffing and used for delivery.

AS A RESULT

As a result, the delivery approach for any given engagement, or track within an engagement, is decided implicitly and independently by whoever happens to be making decisions at that moment (executives, Sales, CPs, Delivery leads, etc.), rather than through one shared educated decision.

AND THEN

When these implicit decisions disagree with the type of engagement or client expectation, often it is not fully understood until the symptoms are already visible to the client, or we are at a point that a pivot will require investment.

SO WE NEED

We need a small set of authorized delivery models

That align approach, contract, and methodology standards

Allowing us to improve how we solution, estimate, and deliver

Source: All Hands slides 18 and 23 · Delivery Excellence slides 6 and 11

How we're going about it

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, Chris McComas, Deana Derocha

Every engagement, and every track within a multi-track program, must have an explicitly named delivery model (chosen from a small, standard set) declared before review, staffing, etc. and checked at fixed intervals afterward. The model determines governance, staffing, and authority; it is not inferred after the fact by whoever is doing the work.

STEP 1

Standardize a small set of named models mapped to commercial structure

No SOW is signed without a model name attached to it, and that name determines governance

(e.g., gates vs. PI cadence vs. OKR-anchored backlog)

STEP 2

Treat multi-track programs as portfolios of clearly defined tracks mapped to a model, not one label stretched over the whole account.

Program A:

Track A: Model 1 (backcasted platform build) +Track B: Model 3 (outcomes based page performance improvement)+

Track C: Model 2 (retainer - ops)

STEP 3

Require a kickoff certification.

A named accountable role (Program or Account Lead and Delivery Lead) signs off, at kickoff and at defined checkpoints, that the working model, the staffing, and the contract still agree with each other. Shift from "escalate when it's already broken" into "check before it can break."

STEP 4

Build leading indicators per model.

Make drift visible in week 2 to 4 of a track instead of at the next executive review.

Each model gets 3 to 4 checkable signals (e.g., for Model 1: is there a backcasted plan and is the client tracking to gates; for Model 2: is velocity being reported against contracted throughput)

Oct 16th
Draft Models Gathered

Week of Oct. 26th
Base Model rationalization across groups

Oct 23rd Shifting to Nov 6th
Initial Models Well Defined

Will include iterative reviews with department leads and defined SMEs

Nov 13th
1st Batch of Models & Program "Stack" Guidance

This will be delivered in an agile manner getting quick guidance out in Q4 and iteratively fleshed out and evolved with feedback loops to drive improvements

THE TARGET

MVP done
[Date we are shooting for.]

TEAM

John · Chris

PARTNERS

BU COOs · Delivery Leads · Enterprise Project Management · Client & Commercial teams · Finance

Source: All Hands slides 19, 21 · Play to Win update (John and Chris) · Delivery Excellence slides 7, 9

The stories

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, Chris McComas, Deana Derocha

	STORY	HOW WE MEASURE SUCCESS	SHOOTING FOR	STATUS
THE MVP	Three stories, not one, because all three must work together for this to work.			
1	**Delivery Models** Every deal categorized at qualification into one of 5-6 core models, so pricing and staffing follow a known shape.	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
2	**Contracts** Terms, scope language, and billing matched to the chosen model — no more fixed price with no scope control.	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
3	**Methodology Standards** Clear working practices, so we guide clients into how we work instead of inheriting whatever mix they bring.	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
AFTER THE MVP	Supported by AI: Estimation, Pricing, and Staffing follow once the MVP is solid.			
4	**Estimation** *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
5	**Pricing** *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
6	**Staffing** *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*

Source: All Hands slide 23 (hidden) · Delivery Excellence slide 11 (hidden)

Delivery Models: the four starting models

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, Chris McComas, Deana Derocha

MODEL 1

Fixed Constraint Delivery

A fixed constraint (budget, deadline, or scope) is set, and delivery is planned backward to it.

Key characteristics

- Backcasted plan is mandatory before build starts — no backcast, no green light
- Scope is fixed and baselined at Gate 1; change flows through CR (constraint-impacting) or Scope Bank (parity swaps)
- Phase-gated structure with formal sign-offs
- Squad Lead = Scrum Master
- Success is binary at the end: did it ship, on time, in budget, to spec

MODEL 2

Velocity Based Delivery

A contracted team delivers at a predictable, measurable pace; value is demonstrated through throughput and periodic releases, not a fixed feature list.

Key characteristics

- No fixed scope commitment — backlog is client-prioritized, reordered freely
- Velocity baseline is established and defended
- PI Planning cadence (8–10 weeks) anchors medium-term commitments
- Squad Lead = Scrum Master
- Contract states team capacity/pace is what's being bought — NOT a feature list

MODEL 3

Outcomes Based Delivery

A strategic product partnership; the backlog exists to move measurable business outcomes, not just to ship features.

Key characteristics

- POD Led = Product Owner, with real authority — decision rights and roadmap access should be contractually explicit
- Every backlog item is anchored to an OKR before it enters a sprint
- Client Product Owner co-owns the roadmap (not just consulted)
- Continuous discovery is a funded, scheduled activity
- Quarterly roadmap/OKR review with Exec Sponsor

MODEL 4

Retainer(Site Support Example)

Live Ops/Support retainer running and sustaining what's already been built. This is not new development, this is protecting existing value and responding to it.

Key characteristics

- Scope is reactive + scheduled maintenance
- Governed by SLAs (response/resolution time by severity)
- Staffing is typically lighter-weight and more specialized (support engineers, on-call rotation)
- Escalation tiers are explicit (L1/L2/L3)
- Requires a clear boundary between support and enhancement (CR)
- Often runs alongside another model (e.g., Model 3 team drives new value while Model 4 team keeps the lights on)

Source: All Hands slide 20 · Delivery Excellence slide 8

CRITICAL ENABLERS

Deal to Delivery Playbook: Update

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, Chris McComas, Deana Derocha

WHAT HAS BEEN ACCOMPLISHED

- Problem statement and recommendation drafted (Sept 16).
- Four model examples defined (Sept 16).
- Draft models gathered (Oct 16).

NEXT MILESTONES

- Base Model rationalization across groups: week of Oct 26.
- Initial Models Well Defined: Oct 23, shifting to Nov 6.
- 1st Batch of Models & Program "Stack" Guidance: Nov 13.
- John and Chris are pulling together the problem statement, dependencies, size, and recommendation for the three MVP stories. We'll review what they bring back next time.

WHAT IS IN OUR WAY / WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

- Alignment on base model set (Delivery/Ops, Legal and Finance) and on model definition.
- SME feedback, and intake routing.
- Top risks: missed model(s) from the assessment, poor rollout and communication, and failure to use the models.
- Everyone needs to lean in, support development of, and use these models. Participate, provide insights, give feedback, and embrace this initiative.

CRITICAL ENABLERS

Accountability Framework

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, John Ewen

CRITICAL ENABLERS

Accountability Framework: Context

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, John Ewen

2026 GOAL

Codify and transform delivery leadership and accountability for every project, with clear delivery roles, executive sponsorship, and regular reviews that highlight high-risk projects.

- In practice: every key project has named delivery roles and an executive sponsor, multitrack projects have agreed accountability, and quarterly reviews surface high-risk projects early.

THE PROBLEM

- We are refining how we manage multitrack projects so project teams have precise leadership support, rather than running as one giant portfolio.
- For multitrack and multi-Delivery Center projects, alignment needs to be agreed to and enforced.
- This will inform everything from staffing to methodology to the role of escalation management and resolution.

WHAT WE ARE CHANGING

- We will define accountability for every project.
- We will establish the essential delivery roles needed and clarify existing roles to avoid overlap and gaps.
- We are launching a workstream to define standard delivery roles and establish clear, supportive project-level structures across all major accounts.
- Starting in Q4, we will establish a cadence of quarterly reviews. High risk projects will be highlighted in ongoing Delivery Excellence meetings.

WHAT THIS UNLOCKS

- Delivery doesn't happen in a vacuum. Successes and escalations are tightly coupled with our Client Engagement model (Client Partners, Account Management) and Executive Sponsors.
- **Beyond the MVP**
- Expand quarterly reviews across the broader portfolio after the top 5 major clients per BU, and scale what works into methodology.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Far too many key projects lack a shared understanding of who is accountable for the work that we do.

Why now

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, John Ewen

[Why this one, and why now? One or two sentences: what it costs us today.]

WHAT'S HAPPENING TODAY

To best support our integrated business units, we are refining how we manage accounts with multiple projects or multitrack projects to ensure project teams have precise leadership support, rather than running as one giant portfolio.

AS A RESULT

[...]

AND THEN

[...]

SO WE NEED

[What we need]

[What we need]

[What we need]

Source: All Hands slide 25 · Delivery Excellence slide 13

How we're going about it

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, John Ewen

We are launching a workstream to define standard delivery roles and establish clear, supportive project-level structures across all major accounts.

STEP 1

Accountability Clarified

We will define accountability for every project. For projects serviced by a single Delivery Center, this will be linear and familiar. For multitrack/multi-Delivery Center projects, alignment needs to be agreed to and enforced. This will inform everything from staffing to methodology to the role of escalation management and resolution.

[Date]
[Milestone]

STEP 2

Defining Essential Roles

As new accountability models are defined, new roles may be necessary. We will establish the essential delivery roles needed to support this model and clarify existing roles to avoid overlap and gaps.

[Date]
[Milestone]

STEP 3

Growth, Client Service and Executive Sponsorship

Delivery doesn't happen in a vacuum. Successes and escalations will need to be tightly coupled with our Client Engagement model (Client Partners, Account Management) and Executive Sponsors. These partnerships will be evaluated for clarity, completeness and effectiveness with our modified delivery engine.

[Date]
[Milestone]

STEP 4

Change Management will be Key

These changes will represent modifications to our ways of working and new standards which we will need to taught, supported and enforced. Training and continuous improvement will be key to helping the organization embrace new structures and ensure we learn from what works.

[Date]
[Milestone]

STEP 5

Phased Rollout of Regular Reviews

Starting in Q4, we will establish a cadence of quarterly reviews to report on the accountability structure for multitrack programs. Each model will be assessed in terms of risk and opportunities for improvement. Additionally, high risk projects will be highlighted in ongoing Delivery Excellence meetings.

THE TARGET

MVP done

[Date we are shooting for.]

TEAM

BU COOs · **Enterprise Project Management**

PARTNERS

[Partner] · *[Partner]*

Source: All Hands slide 25 · Delivery Excellence slide 13 (BU COOs and Enterprise Project Management co-lead)

The stories

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, John Ewen

	STORY	HOW WE MEASURE SUCCESS	SHOOTING FOR	STATUS
THE MVP				
1	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
2	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
3	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
AFTER THE MVP				
4	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
5	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*

CRITICAL ENABLERS

Accountability Framework: Update

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, John Ewen

WHAT HAS BEEN ACCOMPLISHED

- Workstream launching to define standard delivery roles and project-level structures across major accounts.
- BU COOs and Enterprise Project Management are co-leading this initiative.

NEXT MILESTONES

- Lock in the key accounts in each BU (top 5 major clients per BU): [enter date].
- Define the required core roles for the Q4 launch: [enter date].
- Start the quarterly reviews of the accountability structure for multitrack programs: Q4.

WHAT IS IN OUR WAY / WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

- Key accounts in each BU are not yet locked in, and core roles for the Q4 launch are not yet defined.
- Change management will be key. These are modifications to our ways of working and new standards that we will need to teach, support, and enforce.
- Training and continuous improvement will help the organization embrace new structures and ensure we learn from what works.



OPS PRIORITIES

Leadership Dashboards

OWNER(S)
[Names]

OPS PRIORITIES · EXEC SUMMARY

Leadership Dashboards

Owner(s)
[Names]

2026 GOAL

[...]

THE PROBLEM

We lack a singular place for leaders to go to see the health of their business.

Resource and financial data sit in separate systems, with no rate cards applied, no burn tracking, and no cross-BU revenue visibility (see Ugam/HelloWorld).

WHAT WE ARE CHANGING

[...]

WHAT THIS UNLOCKS

[...]

KEY TAKEAWAY

One Set of Numbers: One place to see the metrics that today live in too many reports — with AI doing the reconciliation, not a person.

Source: All Hands slide 27 · Delivery Excellence slide 15

Why now

Owner(s)
[Names]

[Why this one, and why now? One or two sentences: what it costs us today.]

WHAT WE NEED TO SOLVE

One leadership dashboard, not just a data-reconciliation project.

It needs to show revenue, margin, and capacity forecasts, manage rate cards and actuals-for-burn, and tie revenue recognition to operational reporting, all in a single page view.

WHY?

We're running the business off lagging metrics or incomplete ones. Example: We can see client or project margin but not practice margin. And costs live in a Finance spreadsheet that we see once a month.

SO WE NEED

[What we need]

[What we need]

[What we need]

Source: All Hands slide 27 · Delivery Excellence slide 15

How we're going about it

Owner(s)
[Names]

[One line on how we are going about it.]

STEP 1

Preliminary Thoughts

- Dashboard of key metrics by BU (margin, revenue actuals compared to budget), top clients, average client margin, etc, that can be broken down by practice, L3, etc.
- Will link out to existing reports for more details – no need to recreate the wheel for all metrics.
- May need to be locked down to only key leaders based on what is included.

[Date]
[Milestone]

[Date]
[Milestone]

[Date]
[Milestone]

THE TARGET

MVP done
[Date we are shooting for.]

TEAM

[Name] *[Name]*

PARTNERS

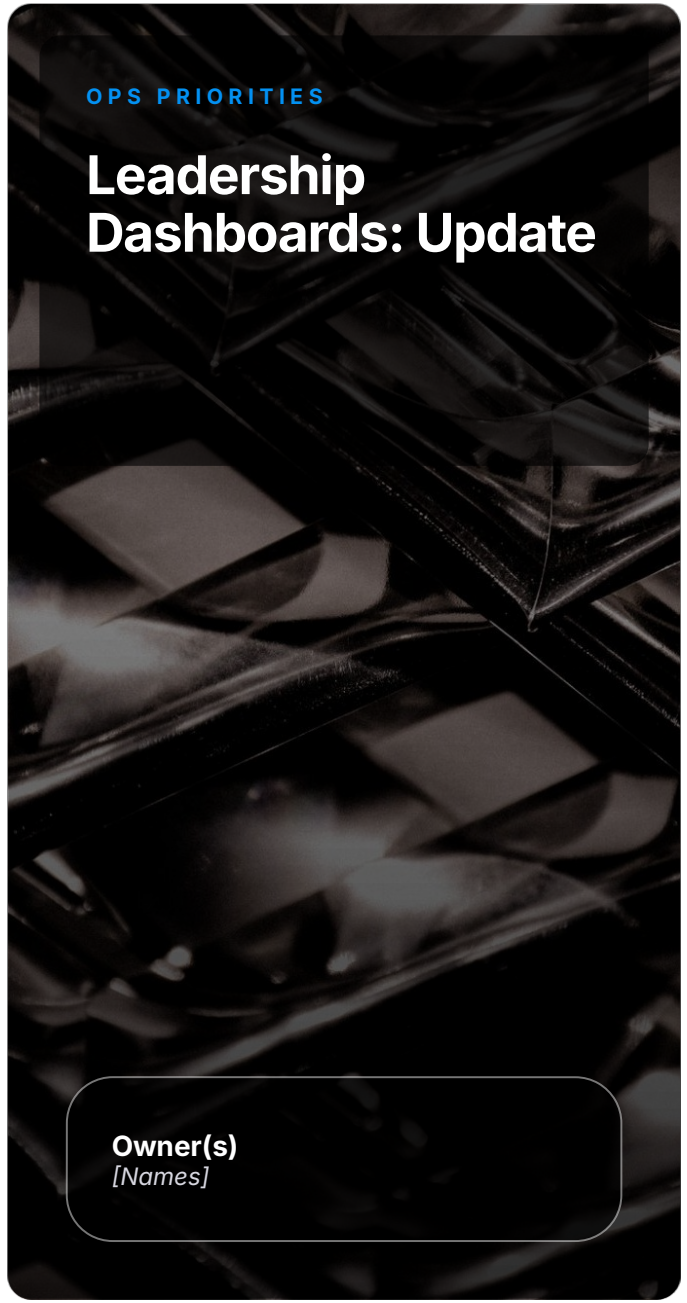
[Partner] *[Partner]*

Source: All Hands slide 27 · Delivery Excellence slide 15

The stories

Owner(s)
[Names]

	STORY	HOW WE MEASURE SUCCESS	SHOOTING FOR	STATUS
THE MVP				
1	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
2	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
3	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
AFTER THE MVP				
4	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
5	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]



OPS PRIORITIES

Leadership Dashboards: Update

Owner(s)
[Names]

WHAT HAS BEEN ACCOMPLISHED

[What has moved since last time. Use dates, not "recently".]

NEXT MILESTONES

[Next milestones, with real dates.]

WHAT IS IN OUR WAY / WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

[What is in the way, including top risks and dependencies. And the specific ask: who, by when.]



OPS PRIORITIES

Capacity Planning & Romulus

OWNER(S)

[Names]

OPS PRIORITIES · EXEC SUMMARY

Capacity Planning & Romulus

Owner(s)
[Names]

2026 GOAL

Move from insight to action: close the skills and bench visibility gap so we can staff ahead of demand.

THE PROBLEM

[...]

WHAT WE ARE CHANGING

[...]

WHAT THIS UNLOCKS

[...]

KEY TAKEAWAY

Next, we need further definition and to identify the dependencies that could block us. The three pillars are where our stories will come from, and we will shape them together with our other priorities (Leadership Dashboards, the Accountability Framework, the Deal-to-Delivery Playbook). Still coming, with more in the coming weeks.

Source: All Hands slide 29 · Delivery Excellence slide 26

Why now

Owner(s)
[Names]

[Why this one, and why now? One or two sentences: what it costs us today.]

WHAT'S HAPPENING TODAY
[...]

AS A RESULT
[...]

AND THEN
[...]

SO WE NEED

[What we need]

[What we need]

[What we need]

How we're going about it

Owner(s)
[Names]

[One line on how we are going about it.]

STEP 1
[Step name]
[What it is, in plain words.]

STEP 2
[Step name]
[What it is, in plain words.]

STEP 3
[Step name]
[What it is, in plain words.]

STEP 4
[Step name]
[What it is, in plain words.]

This year
We started with resource management, then stood up capacity planning.

Coming weeks
Like our other ops top priorities, we will build this out as an epic with stories underneath, so we can focus and prioritize.

Late October
FIRST FEATURES GO LIVE · FULL DEMO: Next Ops Town Hall

See the complete experience in action.

Next year
Capacity planning becomes how we run things and our priority focus for enhancement, with resource management as its child.

THE TARGET

MVP done
[Date we are shooting for.]

TEAM

[Name] *[Name]*

PARTNERS

[Partner] *[Partner]*

Source: All Hands slides 29 and 33 · Delivery Excellence slide 26 (which says Mid-November, not Late October)

The stories

Owner(s)
[Names]

THE STORIES

	STORY	HOW WE MEASURE SUCCESS	SHOOTING FOR	STATUS
1	**Pillar 1: Know who we have** **We need** skills captured in one place we can search, **so we can** find the right person for a role across practices. **The outcome:** one trusted view of skills instead of separate sources. A skills data pilot with about 100 opt-in people from each of two teams, on a LinkedIn skills taxonomy. We still need to define what we need from it.	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	UNDERWAY
2	**Pillar 2: See what is coming** **We need** to review SF stages to see the pipeline earlier, **so we can** plan people around demand with RM pulled in earlier in the process, not at signature. **The outcome:** teams that are ready to start instead of scrambling after signing. Smart Bench is a concept we are exploring. In plain terms: look ahead at what is likely to close, set clear rules for when we add or reduce capacity (hire, temporary help, or an outside partner), and plan how quickly people ramp on. What it means for us is still being defined.	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	**Exploring: Smart Bench**
3	**Pillar 3: One place to look** **We need** what we check today brought into one connected view, **so we can** move from insight to action with fewer places to look. **The outcome:** insight that points to the next move. Today we check Salesforce, Workfront, pricing tools, spreadsheets, and SharePoint. Romulus is the tool we are building to help turn insight into action (next slide). It needs more feeding from the work in the other two pillars.	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	**Being built: Romulus**

Source: All Hands slide 29 · Delivery Excellence slide 26 (pillar 2 wording differs)

Romulus

Owner(s)
[Names]

An operating system for resource management.

Romulus turns live demand, supply and financial data into a daily situation report — surfacing the staffing decisions a Resource Manager needs to make **before they're asked**. It's built to replace the spreadsheets, email chains, and tribal knowledge our business runs on today.

▲ *This was the actual prompt that started it all* ▲

Now here's the rest of the story.... In 3 minutes (or less)

What you can do with it

Owner(s)
[Names]

1

See today’s situation

The morning briefing — overall health, the single most important finding, and the day’s top moves.

2

Suggest resources for open roles

Ranked candidates with fit rationale, availability, and recent project history.

3

Run what-if scenarios

Model a deal landing, a start date slipping, or filling from the bench — before committing.

4

Walk a decision through governance

Approval stages with policy checks surfaced at each gate. Full audit trail.

5

Ask in plain language

A conversational assistant grounded in current, real data — not general knowledge.

Source: All Hands slide 33 · Delivery Excellence slide 29

OPS PRIORITIES

Capacity Planning & Romulus: Update



Owner(s)
[Names]

WHAT HAS BEEN ACCOMPLISHED

[What has moved since last time. Use dates, not "recently".]

NEXT MILESTONES

[Next milestones, with real dates.]

WHAT IS IN OUR WAY / WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

[What is in the way, including top risks and dependencies. And the specific ask: who, by when.]



OPS PRIORITIES

DGS Leadership Transition

OWNER(S)

[Names]

OPS PRIORITIES · EXEC SUMMARY

DGS Leadership Transition

Owner(s)
[Names]

2026 GOAL

[...]

THE PROBLEM

[...]

WHAT WE ARE CHANGING

[...]

WHAT THIS UNLOCKS

[...]

KEY TAKEAWAY

We have a hard deadline and a business with real complexity underneath it. This two-phase plan is how we capture the knowledge, resolve ownership, and land a clean transition by year-end.

Source: All Hands slide 35

Why now

Owner(s)
[Names]

Why this one, now: Naazneen's departure on 12/31 is a fixed deadline, and her role covers more ground than any one market realizes — global delivery, market relationships, capability development, and financial oversight. This is a two-phase effort to capture what she knows and put durable ownership in place before she leaves.

WHAT'S HAPPENING TODAY	AS A RESULT	AND THEN
[...]	*[...]*	*[...]*

SO WE NEED

[What we need]	*[What we need]*	*[What we need]*

Source: All Hands slide 35

How we're going about it

Owner(s)
[Names]

[One line on how we are going about it.]

STEP 1

PHASE 1 · Intake, Validate, Plan · Sept 14 – Oct 16
Milestone: India trip Sept 25 – Oct 10 (AO)

Role & Org Mapping

Sessions with Naazneen's team to document formal and informal responsibilities, relationships, and escalation paths.

Coverage & Role Design

Determine who — and # of people — are needed to take on what Naazneen has been doing. Separate the DBT-specific work from the broader set of responsibilities she carries.

Alignment Prep

Establish scope, decision rights, and messaging ahead of wider stakeholder engagement.

STEP 2

PHASE 2 · Align, Anchor, Execute · Oct 19 – Dec 20
Milestone: India trip mid-Nov (AO, Missy, Eric, McComas)

Operating Model Decisions

Finalize market vs. India ownership of delivery escalation, solutioning participation, and shared governance.

Leadership & Talent Plan

Confirm critical role coverage, succession, recruiting priorities, and capability gaps.

Execution & Handoff

Complete transition activities and communications ahead of the 12/31 departure.

STEP 3

Extentia's Organic Revenue

Multi-market structure (US, ANZ, India, UK) and P&L ownership need to be resolved for 2027 — likely a longer runway than the core transition timeline. Tracking separately so it doesn't block Phase 1 & 2 progress.

Sept 14 – Oct 16
Phase 1: Intake, Validate, Plan
Milestone: India trip Sept 25 – Oct 10 (AO)

Oct 19 – Dec 20
Phase 2: Align, Anchor, Execute
Milestone: India trip mid-Nov (AO, Missy, Eric, McComas)

THE TARGET

12/31
Naazneen departs.

TEAM

[Name] *[Name]*

PARTNERS

[Partner] *[Partner]*

Source: All Hands slide 35 and divider slide 34

The stories

Owner(s)
[Names]

	STORY	HOW WE MEASURE SUCCESS	SHOOTING FOR	STATUS
THE MVP				
1	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
2	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
3	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
AFTER THE MVP				
4	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
5	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]

DGS Leadership Transition

Owner(s)
[Names]

MAPPING NAAZNEEN

Over the course of the trip I completed more than 30 intake interviews across DGS team members. We covered:

- Our ways of working
- How resources are identified
- How the are trained and deployed
- How the build their careers

UNDERSTANDING HOW THEY SUPPORT CXM

They view the US as a market, they don't see the business units per se. Which lead to conversations around:

- They other markets and how they operate.
- Organic projects beyond the markets
- How they create craft communities

AN INTERIM MODEL

Naazneen's departure creates a sizable hole in the business, but she has a good team of lieutenants.

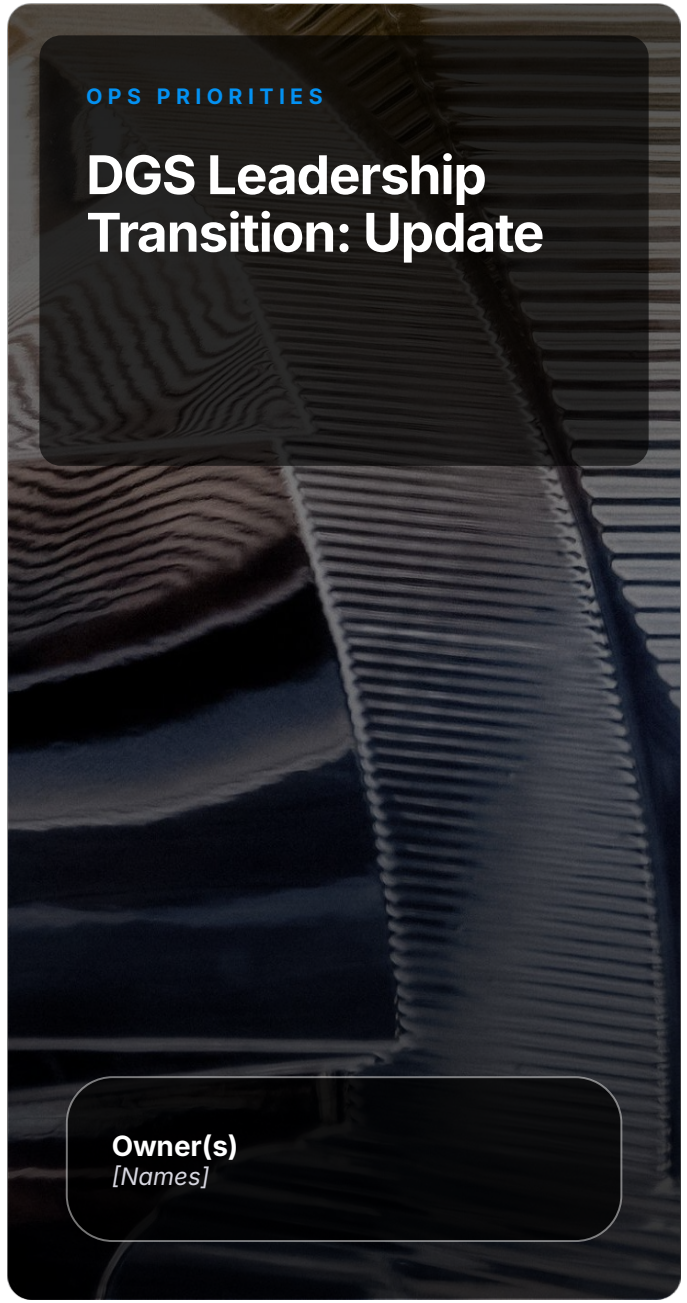
- An interim model leveraging her lieutenants has been identified
- Ongoing interviews for Naaz's backfill.
- Could be sometime in Q1 before the role I filled

BACK TO INDIA

In mid-November, we'll make another trip to India. This trip will include:

- Key leaders from DBT, Missy and AO
- Care and feeding of the team through the transition.
- Building toward the future with our ways of working and staffing.

Source: All Hands slide 36



OPS PRIORITIES

DGS Leadership Transition: Update

Owner(s)
[Names]

WHAT HAS BEEN ACCOMPLISHED

[What has moved since last time. Use dates, not "recently".]

NEXT MILESTONES

[Next milestones, with real dates.]

WHAT IS IN OUR WAY / WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

[What is in the way, including top risks and dependencies. And the specific ask: who, by when.]

CRITICAL ENABLERS

Intake Updates

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, McComas, Deana, John E.

CRITICAL ENABLERS

Intake Updates: Context

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, McComas, Deana, John E.

2026 GOAL

[Enter 2026 goal, and what it means in practice]

THE PROBLEM

- Adoption has been slow: people still go to known individuals for help, cutting into BU visibility and our ability to help.
- C&C has been informed of the alias and process.

WHAT WE ARE CHANGING

- DDM_Opportunity and DBT_Opportunity are live, so requests reach the right BU SMEs without needing to know a matrix of names.
- Requests are reviewed and assigned to a lead within the BU. The lead gathers more info, pulls in solutioning support, and makes sure the request is handled: creds, calls, PT entry.
- SME Case Request in SF (10/16 target): covers deals under $500K, small ad-hoc projects, multi-person sprints, exec meetings, and case studies.
- RACI updates (11/1 estimated): clarify roles for everyone in intake.

WHAT THIS UNLOCKS

- Requests get emailed to the right alias and land in a list for easy review and follow-up.
- SME expertise comes in earlier, before the deal is shaped, which can lift our win rate on the deal volume we already capture.
- **Beyond the MVP**

[Enter what this makes possible next]

KEY TAKEAWAY

Upstream of Delivery Models: how a request even reaches the right people before it becomes a deal.

Why now

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, McComas, Deana, John E.

[Why this one, and why now? One or two sentences: what it costs us today.]

WHAT'S HAPPENING TODAY
[...]

AS A RESULT
[...]

AND THEN
[...]

SO WE NEED

[What we need]

[What we need]

[What we need]

How we're going about it

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, McComas, Deana, John E.

[One line on how we are going about it.]

STEP 1

What's behind the alias

- Request is reviewed and assigned to a lead within the BU
- Lead reaches out to gather more info, pulls in solutioning support, and ensures the request is handled — creds, calls, PT entry, etc.

10/16 target launch date
SME Case Request in SF

11/1 Estimated Rollout
RACI Updates

THE TARGET

MVP done
[Date we are shooting for.]

TEAM

[Name] *[Name]*

PARTNERS

[Partner] *[Partner]*

Source: All Hands slide 38 · Delivery Excellence slide 17

The stories

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, McComas, Deana, John E.

THE STORIES

	STORY	HOW WE MEASURE SUCCESS	SHOOTING FOR	STATUS
1	**Alias Creation** **DDM_Opportunity@merkle.com** and **DBT_Opportunity@merkle.com** are live, so requests reach the right BU SMEs without needing to know a matrix of names.	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
2	**Adoption** • C&C has been informed of the alias and process • Adoption has been slow: People still go to known individuals for help, cutting into BU visibility and ability to help	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
3	**Leadership Ask** • C&C leadership support in redirecting request	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
4	**SME Case Request in SF – 10/16 target launch date** Updating the existing tool to cover more scenarios: • New pursuit or deals under $500k • Ad-hoc client request for a small new project • Sprints involving multiple people • Client exec-level meetings needing decks and materials • Case studies, capability decks, etc.	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*
5	**RACI Updates – 11/1 Estimated Rollout** Underway, to clearly articulate roles and responsibilities for everyone involved in the intake process.	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	*[STATUS]*

Source: All Hands slide 38 · Delivery Excellence slide 17

CRITICAL ENABLERS

Intake Updates: Update

Owner(s)
Missy Foristall, McComas, Deana, John E.

WHAT HAS BEEN ACCOMPLISHED

- Alias creation complete: DDM_Opportunity and DBT_Opportunity are live.
- C&C has been informed of the alias and process.

NEXT MILESTONES

- SME Case Request in SF: 10/16 target launch date.
- RACI updates: 11/1 estimated rollout.

WHAT IS IN OUR WAY / WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

- Adoption has been slow: people still go to known individuals for help, cutting into BU visibility and ability to help.
- Leadership ask: C&C leadership support in redirecting request.



OPS PRIORITIES

Ops Transformation: Rebuild Scoping & Staffing

OWNER(S)

[Names]

OPS PRIORITIES · EXEC SUMMARY

Ops Transformation: Rebuild Scoping & Staffing

Owner(s)
[Names]

2026 GOAL

[...]

THE PROBLEM

[...]

WHAT WE ARE CHANGING

[...]

WHAT THIS UNLOCKS

[...]

KEY TAKEAWAY

Deliverables go in, and a timeline and staffing plan come out. AI does the real work of generating the plan, and gets smarter from what we actually deliver.

Source: Delivery Excellence kickoff slide 19

Why now

Owner(s)
[Names]

[Why this one, and why now? One or two sentences: what it costs us today.]

WHAT'S HAPPENING TODAY
[...]

AS A RESULT
[...]

AND THEN
[...]

SO WE NEED

[What we need]

[What we need]

[What we need]

How we're going about it

Owner(s)
[Names]

This is a new ask, and we are still working through it. More to come.

STEP 1

Goes In

Deliverables

STEP 2

Ai Does The Real Work

Generating the plan

STEP 3

Comes Out

Timeline + staffing plan

[Date]
[Milestone]

[Date]
[Milestone]

[Date]
[Milestone]

[Date]
[Milestone]

THE TARGET

MVP done
[Date we are shooting for.]

TEAM

[Name] *[Name]*

PARTNERS

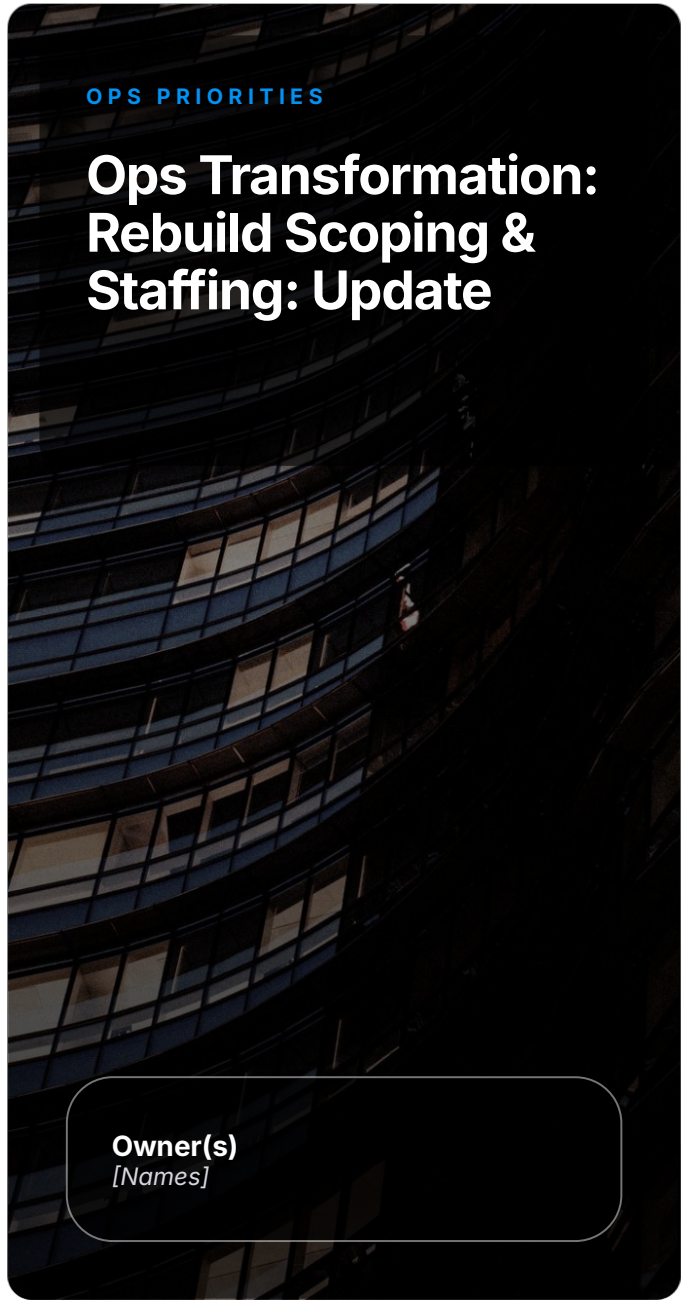
[Partner] *[Partner]*

Source: Delivery Excellence kickoff slide 19

The stories

Owner(s)
[Names]

	STORY	HOW WE MEASURE SUCCESS	SHOOTING FOR	STATUS
THE MVP				
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3	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
AFTER THE MVP				
4	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
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OPS PRIORITIES

Ops Transformation: Rebuild Scoping & Staffing: Update

Owner(s)
[Names]

WHAT HAS BEEN ACCOMPLISHED

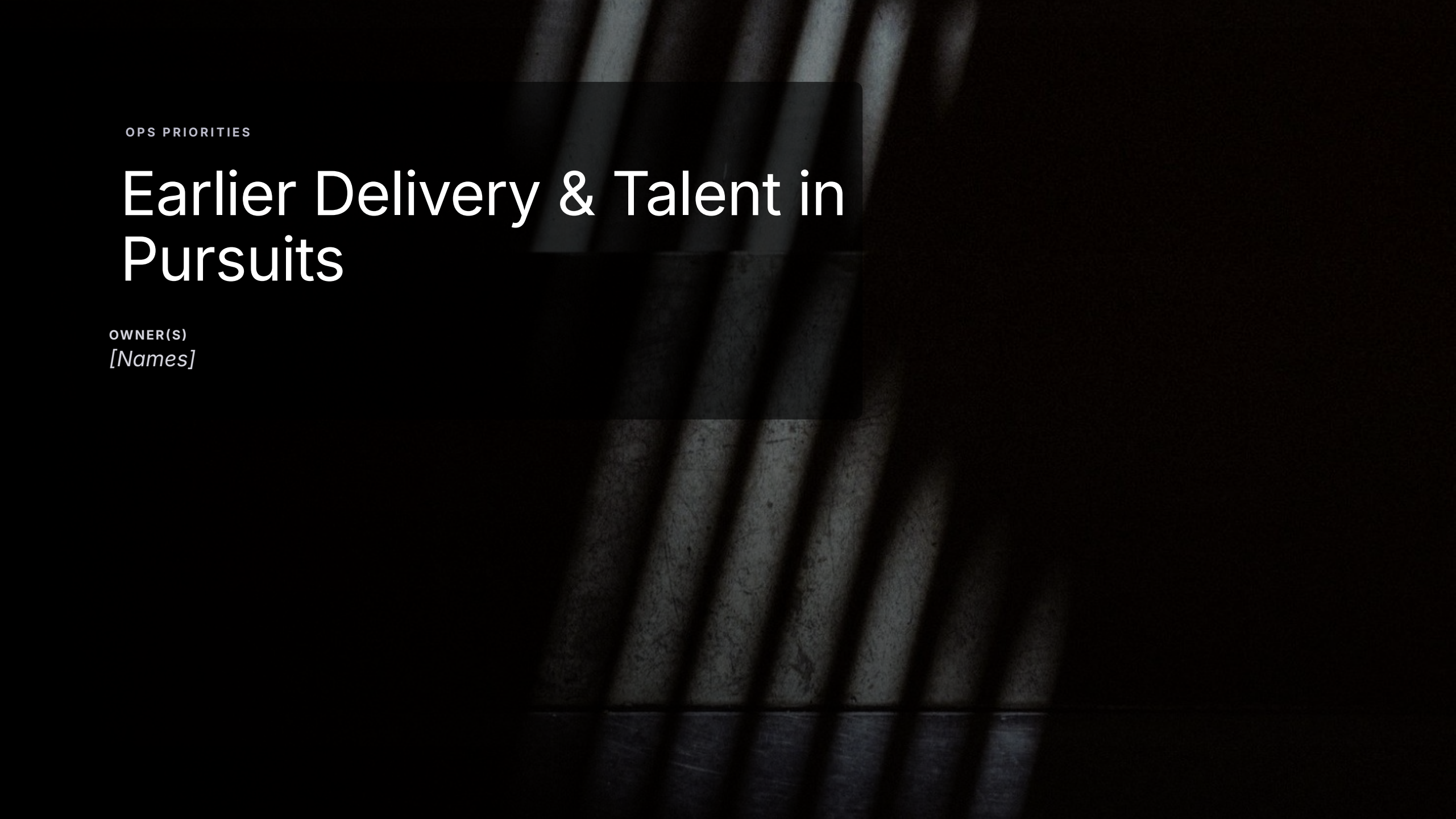
[What has moved since last time. Use dates, not "recently".]

NEXT MILESTONES

[Next milestones, with real dates.]

WHAT IS IN OUR WAY / WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

[What is in the way, including top risks and dependencies. And the specific ask: who, by when.]



OPS PRIORITIES

Earlier Delivery & Talent in Pursuits

OWNER(S)
[Names]

OPS PRIORITIES · EXEC SUMMARY

Earlier Delivery & Talent in Pursuits

Owner(s)
[Names]

2026 GOAL

[...]

THE PROBLEM

[...]

WHAT WE ARE CHANGING

[...]

WHAT THIS UNLOCKS

[...]

KEY TAKEAWAY

Without clear roles tied to supporting pitch and pursuit, we continue to pull delivery resources that are fully allocated into conversations that they can't give the appropriate attention to. This will continue to be a problem until we get the right skillsets with the right availability identified and in place.

Source: All Hands slide 40 · Delivery Excellence slide 21

Why now

Owner(s)
[Names]

Why this one, now: By bringing SME expertise into upfront deal evaluation, we can increase our win rate on the deal volume we're already capturing. Quick execution is essential to drive Q4 and 2027 revenue.

WHAT'S HAPPENING TODAY	AS A RESULT	AND THEN
[...]	*[...]*	*[...]*

SO WE NEED

[What we need]	*[What we need]*	*[What we need]*

Source: All Hands slide 40 · Delivery Excellence slide 21

How we're going about it

Owner(s)
[Names]

[One line on how we are going about it.]

STEP 1

PHASE 1 · Planning and Discovery: Now – 10/30

Define Roles Needed

Determine the specific roles need for pursuit support (alliance partner, skillset) along with allocations, roles and responsibilities

Clarify if Internal or External Moves

Review existing team roster to see who can move to these new roles and where we need to hire

Update Existing Org Structure

Update the existing org structure (as needed) to best support these roles and the pursuits

STEP 2

PHASE 2 · Execution on Changes: 11/2 – 12/24

Open Reqs

Once aligned on the needs, prioritize needs and open reqs for the first set of new roles (or for backfills, if moving existing people into the new roles)

Create Transition Plan

Identify any accounts that need to move to allow people to switch to a new role and create a 30/60 day transition plan

Now – 10/30
Planning and Discovery

11/2 – 12/24
Execution on Changes

THE TARGET

MVP done
[Date we are shooting for.]

TEAM

[Name] *[Name]*

PARTNERS

[Partner] *[Partner]*

Source: All Hands slide 40 · Delivery Excellence slide 21

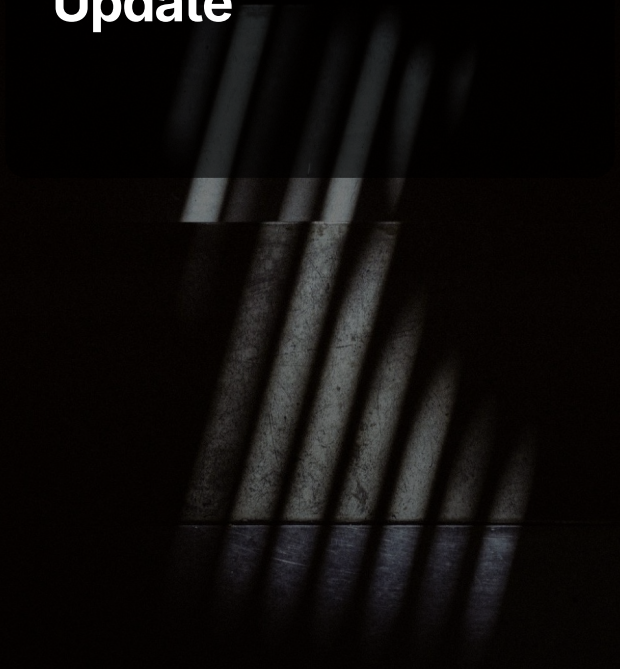
The stories

Owner(s)
[Names]

	STORY	HOW WE MEASURE SUCCESS	SHOOTING FOR	STATUS
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2	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
3	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
AFTER THE MVP				
4	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]
5	*[Story name]* *[What it is, in plain words.]*	*[How we will know it is working.]*	*[Date]*	[STATUS]

OPS PRIORITIES

Earlier Delivery & Talent in Pursuits: Update



Owner(s)
[Names]

WHAT HAS BEEN ACCOMPLISHED

[What has moved since last time. Use dates, not "recently".]

NEXT MILESTONES

[Next milestones, with real dates.]

WHAT IS IN OUR WAY / WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

[What is in the way, including top risks and dependencies. And the specific ask: who, by when.]

LAYOUT 1 · COLUMNS · TEMPLATE · SUPPORTING DETAIL

[Add a header]

[ADD A HEADER]

[Two to four columns. Use for categories, options, models or examples: a name, a line on what it is, and a few key points.]

[ADD A HEADER]

[Two to four columns. Use for categories, options, models or examples: a name, a line on what it is, and a few key points.]

[ADD A HEADER]

[Two to four columns. Use for categories, options, models or examples: a name, a line on what it is, and a few key points.]

[ADD A HEADER]

[Two to four columns. Use for categories, options, models or examples: a name, a line on what it is, and a few key points.]

[Add a header]

PHASE 1 · [NAME] · [DATES]

[Milestone, if there is one.]

[Step]
[What happens, in plain words.]

[Step]
[What happens, in plain words.]

[Step]
[What happens, in plain words.]

PHASE 2 · [NAME] · [DATES]

[Milestone, if there is one.]

[Step]
[What happens, in plain words.]

[Step]
[What happens, in plain words.]

[Step]
[What happens, in plain words.]

LAYOUT 3 · STATEMENT AND POINTS · SUPPORTING DETAIL

[Add a header]

[One statement: the thing to take away.]

[POINT]

[Supporting detail.]

[POINT]

[Supporting detail.]

[POINT]

[Supporting detail.]

[Optional: a closing line.]

LAYOUT 4 · FLOW · TEMPLATE · SUPPORTING DETAIL

[Add a header]

[One line on what the flow shows.]

[GOES IN]

[...]

[WHAT HAPPENS]

[...]

[COMES OUT]

[...]

[Optional: a closing line, a status, or a caveat.]